PROPOSAL

Sources Sought — Cross-Domain Capabilities

Prepared for:

Location: Detroit, MI

Date: November 09, 2026

Prepared by: Carl E. Jones III

Hidden Leaf Networks LLC — Detroit, Michigan — hiddenleafnetworks.com

SOURCES SOUGHT RESPONSE

Date: November 09, 2026 **Reference:** PANAPG-27-P-0000-057694 **Subject:** Sources Sought — Cross-Domain Capabilities **NAICS Code:** 541512

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From: Carl E. Jones III, Founder & Principal Hidden Leaf Networks, LLC Detroit, Michigan carl@hiddenleafnetworks.com https://www.hiddenleafnetworks.com

1. Company Identification

Field	Value
Legal Name	HIDDEN LEAF NETWORKS, LLC
CAGE Code	26PF4
UEI	X6B2SPZ64KP3
SAM.gov Status	Active
Business Size	Small Business
Business Type	Single-Member LLC
Primary NAICS	541512 — Computer Systems Design Services
Additional NAICS	541519, 541511
Location	Detroit, Michigan
Year Established	2025

2. Capability Overview

Hidden Leaf Networks, LLC (HLN) is a Detroit-based small technology firm with deep expertise in multi-domain systems integration, secure API architecture, and AI-powered workflow orchestration. Cross-domain capability development — in its broadest sense — is architecturally central to HLN's work: building systems that move structured data securely across organizational boundaries, trust

domains, and classification tiers.

HLN understands Army cross-domain requirements to encompass the ability to transfer data between networks of differing security classifications in a controlled, auditable, and policy-enforced manner. HLN's software engineering capabilities apply directly to the application and middleware layers of cross-domain solution (CDS) ecosystems, including content inspection tooling, data transformation pipelines, and administrative workflow interfaces.

Core Capabilities Relevant to This Requirement:

- Secure API development with structured data validation, schema enforcement, and content filtering — foundational to cross-domain transfer pipelines
- Multi-tenant, role-based access control architectures with strict privilege separation — aligning with cross-domain guard configuration principles
- Data transformation and normalization pipelines — structured extraction, format conversion, and policy-based filtering
- Automated testing frameworks for security-critical systems — 500+ test cases across HLN platforms, with emphasis on boundary condition coverage
- AI-augmented content analysis — classification, tagging, and anomaly detection applicable to cross-domain content inspection workflows
- Audit logging, compliance documentation, and chain-of-custody tooling for sensitive data movement
- Integration experience with government-adjacent standards: NIST 800-53, FISMA requirements, DoD STIGs as architectural reference

HLN's **HLN Relay** platform demonstrates relevant architectural depth — a multi-layer system with strict interface contracts between security tiers, role-adaptive interfaces that enforce need-to-know boundaries, and an orchestration engine designed to mediate workflows across organizational trust boundaries. While not a certified cross-domain solution, its architecture directly reflects the design principles governing CDSs.

3. Relevant Experience

HLN is a newly established LLC without federal contract past performance. The principal engineer brings extensive directly applicable systems engineering experience:

Carl E. Jones III — Founder & Principal Engineer

- 12+ years in systems engineering, software quality assurance, and enterprise integration
- Automotive systems engineering at Ford Motor Company — complex integration across multi-vendor, multi-domain software environments with strict quality gate enforcement
- Architecture and development of multi-domain software systems: data isolation layers, API boundary enforcement, structured message validation
- Full-stack security-aware development: Python, TypeScript, FastAPI, Docker, PostgreSQL — with emphasis on data integrity, input sanitization, and audit trails
- AI pipeline architecture — multi-model orchestration with structured output enforcement and content inspection applicable to CDS-adjacent tooling
- Experience building systems that enforce strict interface contracts between application layers — directly applicable to cross-domain guard software integration

HLN notes transparently that certified Cross-Domain Solution hardware/firmware development is a specialized capability requiring dedicated partnerships with accredited CDS vendors. HLN's value in this environment is as a software integrator, tooling developer, and application-layer specialist supporting established CDS program teams.

4. Teaming Arrangements

HLN is interested in this opportunity as a teaming partner — bringing agile application development, AI workflow tooling, and test automation capabilities to complement teams holding existing CDS accreditations and program experience. HLN actively seeks introductions to firms with TSABI, RAISE, or other Army cross-domain program experience.

HLN is specifically well-suited as a subcontractor for:

- Administrative interface development for cross-domain guard management
- Automated testing and quality assurance for cross-domain software components
- AI-assisted content inspection tooling development
- Audit and compliance reporting tooling

5. Questions for the Contracting Officer

1. Is this requirement focused on cross-domain solution (CDS) hardware/firmware development, application-layer software integration, or program support services — or a combination?

2. Will the requirement include software development for CDS management interfaces, administrative tools, or content inspection pipelines, in addition to or separate from core CDS guard development?

3. What is the anticipated clearance level for primary performance, and are there components that could be performed at Secret or below?

4. Will DISA Unified Cross Domain Services Management Office (UCDSMO) accreditation experience be a mandatory qualification, or will teaming with accredited partners be acceptable?

5. Is the Army anticipating a small business set-aside for any portion of this requirement?

6. Interest Level

Hidden Leaf Networks, LLC expresses **strong interest** in this opportunity, particularly in a subcontractor or teaming partner role focused on application-layer software development, automated testing, AI-augmented content analysis tooling, and compliance documentation. HLN is a registered small business under NAICS 541512.

HLN is prepared to provide a capability briefing, discuss architectural approaches relevant to Army cross-domain requirements, or connect with prime contractors for teaming discussions.

Respectfully submitted,

Carl E. Jones III

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CAGE: 26PF4 | UEI: X6B2SPZ64KP3 | SAM.gov: Active